

Here's the full curation for **shadow**, anchored to the passage phrase **"a shadow on the wall."**  
The full **MCQ-ready master list** is included.

## # SHADOW

### ## 1. Passage anchor

> "Once, she used nothing more than a cup, a torch, and a **shadow on the wall** to explain a difficult idea about light..."

#### ### Passage meaning

**shadow** = a dark shape produced when an object blocks light

**影子；陰影**

Here, Ms. Lau uses the shadow cast by the cup as part of a physics demonstration about light.

#### ### Practice

1. The cup cast a **shadow** on the wall.

杯子在牆上投下了一個**影子**。

2. She moved the torch and showed us how the **shadow** changed.

她移動手電筒，讓我們看到**影子**如何變化。

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## # Core meanings of SHADOW

### ## 2. shadow — dark shape caused by blocked light

= a dark area or shape formed when an object blocks light

**影子；陰影**

This is the exact passage sense.

#### ### Examples

1. The tree cast a long **shadow** across the road.

那棵樹在道路上投下長長的**影子**。

2. I could see his **shadow** on the wall.

我可以看到他在牆上的**影子**。

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### ## 3. cast a shadow

= produce a shadow by blocking light

**\*\*投下影子；形成陰影\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. The building **\*\*cast a shadow\*\*** over the garden.  
那棟建築在花園上**\*\*投下陰影\*\***。
2. The lamp made the object **\*\*cast a sharp shadow\*\***.  
那盞燈讓物體**\*\*投下清晰的影子\*\***。

Very high-value collocation.

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### # Area of darkness / shade

### ## 4. shadow — area of relative darkness

= an area where light is blocked or reduced

**\*\*陰影；暗處\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. She stood in the **\*\*shadow\*\*** of the building.  
她站在建築物的**\*\*陰影裡\*\***。
2. Part of the room remained in **\*\*shadow\*\***.  
房間有一部分仍在**\*\*暗處\*\***。

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### ## 5. in shadow

= in darkness or reduced light

**\*\*在陰影中；光線不足\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. His face was partly **\*\*in shadow\*\***.  
他的臉有一部分處於**\*\*陰影中\*\***。
2. The mountains were **\*\*in shadow\*\*** by late afternoon.  
到了傍晚，山區已經籠罩在**\*\*陰影中\*\***。

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# Faint image / outline

## 6. shadow — faint or dark outline

= dim outline or indistinct shape

\*\*模糊輪廓；暗影\*\*

### Examples

1. I saw a \*\*shadow\*\* move behind the curtain.

我看到窗簾後面有個\*\*暗影\*\*移動。

2. A dark \*\*shadow\*\* appeared in the doorway.

門口出現了一個黑色\*\*輪廓\*\*。

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# Figurative: negative influence

## 7. cast a shadow over something

= make a situation less happy, hopeful, or positive

\*\*給……蒙上陰影；使……受到負面影響\*\*

### Examples

1. The accident \*\*cast a shadow over the celebration\*\*.

那場事故給慶祝活動\*\*蒙上了一層陰影\*\*。

2. The scandal \*\*cast a shadow over his career\*\*.

那場醜聞給他的職涯\*\*蒙上陰影\*\*。

This is a major figurative extension.

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## 8. under the shadow of something

= affected by fear, threat, memory, or negative influence from something

\*\*在……陰影下\*\*

### Examples

1. They grew up \*\*under the shadow of war\*\*.

他們在戰爭的\*\*陰影下\*\*長大。

2. The company operated \*\*under the shadow of uncertainty\*\*.

公司在不確定性的\*\*陰影下\*\*運作。

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# Figurative: lesser copy / former self

## 9. a shadow of someone/something

= a much weaker, smaller, or less impressive version of what someone or something once was

\*\*.....的影子；遠不如從前\*\*

### Examples

1. He was only a \*\*shadow of his former self\*\*.

他已經只是\*\*昔日自己的影子\*\*，遠不如從前。

2. The town is now a \*\*shadow of what it once was\*\*.

這座城鎮如今已經\*\*遠不如昔日繁榮\*\*。

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## 10. shadow of your former self

= much weaker, less healthy, less successful, or less energetic than before

\*\*大不如前；昔日自己的影子\*\*

### Examples

1. After the illness, he was a \*\*shadow of his former self\*\*.

生病之後，他\*\*大不如前\*\*。

2. The team looked like a \*\*shadow of its former self\*\*.

那支球隊看起來\*\*完全失去了昔日水準\*\*。

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# Following someone closely

## 11. shadow — person who follows someone secretly or closely

= person who follows another person to observe them

\*\*跟蹤者；尾隨者\*\*

### ### Examples

1. The detective acted as his \*\*shadow\*\*.

那名偵探像他的\*\*影子一樣跟著他\*\*。

2. He realized he had a \*\*shadow\*\*.

他意識到有人在\*\*跟蹤自己\*\*。

Less common as a noun, but established.

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### ## 12. shadow someone

= follow someone closely, often secretly, in order to observe them

\*\*跟蹤；尾隨\*\*

### ### Examples

1. The police \*\*shadowed the suspect\*\* for several days.

警方\*\*跟蹤那名嫌疑人\*\*好幾天。

2. A reporter \*\*shadowed the minister\*\* throughout the visit.

一名記者在整個訪問期間一路\*\*跟著部長採訪\*\*。

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### # Training / observation

### ## 13. shadow someone — observe them at work

= follow someone during their work in order to learn about the job

\*\*跟隨觀摩；工作見習\*\*

### ### Examples

1. I \*\*shadowed a doctor\*\* for a week.

我\*\*跟隨一名醫生見習\*\*了一星期。

2. New employees sometimes \*\*shadow experienced staff\*\*.

新員工有時會\*\*跟著資深員工觀摩學習\*\*。

This is a very useful modern professional sense.

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## ## 14. job shadowing

= learning about a job by observing someone doing it

**\*\*職場觀摩；工作見習\*\***

### ### Examples

1. The school arranged a **\*\*job-shadowing programme\*\***.  
學校安排了一個**\*\*職場觀摩計畫\*\***。
2. **\*\*Job shadowing\*\*** can help students understand different careers.  
**\*\*工作見習\*\***可以幫助學生了解不同職業。

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## # Politics / opposition role

## ## 15. shadow — opposition counterpart

In parliamentary systems:

= opposition politician assigned to follow and challenge the work of a government minister

**\*\*影子內閣成員；反對黨對應職位\*\***

### ### Examples

1. She became **\*\*shadow education secretary\*\***.  
她成為反對黨的**\*\*影子教育大臣\*\***。
2. The **\*\*shadow minister\*\*** criticized the proposal.  
**\*\*影子大臣\*\***批評了這項提議。

Established political usage.

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## ## 16. shadow cabinet

= group of senior opposition politicians assigned to mirror government ministries

**\*\*影子內閣\*\***

### ### Examples

1. He was appointed to the **\*\*shadow cabinet\*\***.  
他獲任命加入**\*\*影子內閣\*\***。

2. The **shadow cabinet** announced its alternative policy.

**影子內閣**公布了替代政策。

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## # Computing

### ## 17. shadow — duplicate / hidden copy

In technical contexts, **shadow** can refer to a secondary, hidden, or duplicate version of data, memory, files, or systems.

**影子副本；備份 / 鏡像式副本**

#### ### Examples

1. The system keeps a **shadow copy** of the data.

系統保留資料的**影子副本**。

2. A **shadow file** may store related account information.

**影子檔案**可能儲存相關帳戶資訊。

Technical and context-dependent.

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### ## 18. shadow copy

= automatic point-in-time copy of data or files

**影子複本；陰影複製**

#### ### Examples

1. The system created a **shadow copy** before the update.

系統在更新前建立了**影子複本**。

2. The file was restored from a **shadow copy**.

檔案從**影子複本**中還原。

Specialist computing use.

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## # Typography / graphics

### ## 19. shadow — visual effect behind text/object

= darker offset effect used to make text or an object look raised or dimensional

**\*\*陰影效果\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. Add a **\*\*shadow\*\*** to the text.

給文字加上**\*\*陰影效果\*\***。

2. The icon uses a soft **\*\*shadow\*\***.

這個圖示用了柔和的**\*\*陰影\*\***。

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#### ## 20. drop shadow

= shadow effect positioned behind an object or text in graphic design

**\*\*投影；下拉陰影\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. The title has a subtle **\*\*drop shadow\*\***.

標題有一個細微的**\*\*投影效果\*\***。

2. Remove the **\*\*drop shadow\*\*** from the button.

移除按鈕的**\*\*陰影效果\*\***。

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#### # Eye / makeup

#### ## 21. eye shadow / eyeshadow

= coloured cosmetic applied to the eyelids

**\*\*眼影\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. She wore gold **\*\*eyeshadow\*\***.

她用了金色**\*\*眼影\*\***。

2. The makeup artist blended the **\*\*eye shadow\*\*** carefully.

化妝師仔細暈染**\*\*眼影\*\***。

This is a lexicalized compound.

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## # Shadow as persistent presence

### ## 22. be someone's shadow

= follow someone everywhere or stay very close to them

\*\*像影子一樣跟著某人；形影不離\*\*

#### ### Examples

1. The child was his mother's \*\*shadow\*\* all day.

那個孩子整天都\*\*像影子一樣跟著媽媽\*\*。

2. The puppy became my \*\*shadow\*\*.

那隻小狗變得和我\*\*形影不離\*\*。

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## # Fear / suspicion

### ## 23. shadow of doubt

= small amount of uncertainty or suspicion

\*\*一絲懷疑；疑雲\*\*

Usually occurs in:

> beyond a shadow of a doubt

#### ### Examples

1. There is not a \*\*shadow of doubt\*\* in my mind.

我心裡\*\*毫無疑問\*\*。

2. The evidence established the fact \*\*beyond a shadow of a doubt\*\*.

證據把事實證明得\*\*毫無疑問\*\*。

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### ## 24. beyond a shadow of a doubt

= with complete certainty

\*\*毫無疑問；確定無疑\*\*

#### ### Examples

1. She knew **\*\*beyond a shadow of a doubt\*\*** that she was right.  
她**\*\*百分之百確定\*\***自己是對的。

2. The identity was established **\*\*beyond a shadow of a doubt\*\***.  
身分已經**\*\*確定無疑\*\***。

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## # Related forms

### ## 25. shadowy

#### ### A. dark / full of shadows

**\*\*陰暗的；影影綽綽的\*\***

1. A **\*\*shadowy figure\*\*** stood near the door.  
門邊站著一個**\*\*模糊的黑影\*\***。

#### ### B. unclear / mysterious / possibly dishonest

**\*\*神祕的；不明朗的；可疑的\*\***

2. He had links to a **\*\*shadowy organization\*\***.  
他和一個**\*\*神祕可疑的組織\*\***有聯繫。

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### ## 26. overshadow

#### ### A. physically cast shadow over

**\*\*遮蔽；投下陰影\*\***

#### ### B. be more important or impressive than something else

**\*\*使相形失色；蓋過\*\***

#### ### C. negatively affect an event

**\*\*給……蒙上陰影\*\***

### ### Examples

1. The taller building **\*\*overshadowed\*\*** the garden.

較高的建築\*\*遮住了花園的陽光\*\*。

2. Her success \*\*overshadowed\*\* everyone else's achievement.  
她的成功讓其他人的成就\*\*相形失色\*\*。

3. The accident \*\*overshadowed the celebration\*\*.  
那場事故給慶祝活動\*\*蒙上陰影\*\*。

Important family member.

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## ## 27. foreshadow

= indicate or suggest something that will happen later  
\*\*預示；預兆\*\*

### ### Examples

1. The opening scene \*\*foreshadows\*\* the ending.  
開場場景\*\*預示了結局\*\*。
2. His early comments \*\*foreshadowed\*\* later problems.  
他早期的言論\*\*預示了後來的問題\*\*。

Lexically related and useful, though semantically developed.

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## # High-value expressions

### ## 28. cast a long shadow

= continue to have a strong influence, often negative, for a long time  
\*\*留下長遠影響；長期籠罩\*\*

### ### Examples

1. The conflict \*\*cast a long shadow\*\* over the region.  
那場衝突對該地區\*\*留下長遠陰影\*\*。
2. The decision \*\*cast a long shadow\*\* over his career.  
那個決定對他的職涯產生了\*\*長期負面影響\*\*。

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### ## 29. live in someone's shadow

= be less noticed or successful because another person attracts more attention

**\*\*活在某人的陰影下；被某人光芒掩蓋\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. He grew up **\*\*in his brother's shadow\*\***.

他從小一直**\*\*活在哥哥的陰影下\*\***。

2. She refused to remain **\*\*in anyone's shadow\*\***.

她不願一直**\*\*被別人的光芒掩蓋\*\***。

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### ## 30. emerge from someone's shadow

= become independently recognized after being overshadowed

**\*\*走出某人的陰影；建立自己的地位\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. She eventually **\*\*emerged from her mentor's shadow\*\***.

她最終**\*\*走出了導師的光環 / 陰影\*\***，建立自己的地位。

2. The younger player is beginning to **\*\*emerge from his teammate's shadow\*\***.

那位年輕球員正逐漸**\*\*擺脫隊友的光環影響\*\***。

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### # Key contrasts

#### ## 31. shadow vs shade

**\*\*shadow\*\***

= specific dark shape formed when an object blocks light

**\*\*影子\*\***

**\*\*shade\*\***

= area protected from direct sunlight

**\*\*陰涼處；遮蔭\*\***

Compare:

> The tree cast a **\*\*shadow\*\*** on the wall.

> 樹在牆上投下影子。

> We sat in the **shade** under the tree.

> 我們坐在樹下的陰涼處。

They overlap, but are not identical.

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### ## 32. shadow vs reflection

**shadow**

= dark shape caused by blocked light

**reflection**

= image formed when light bounces off a surface

**倒影；映像**

Compare:

> my **shadow** on the wall

> 我在牆上的影子

> my **reflection** in the mirror

> 我在鏡中的倒影

Important physics distinction.

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### ## 33. shadow vs silhouette

**silhouette**

= dark outline of a person/object seen against a lighter background

**剪影；輪廓**

**shadow**

= dark region caused by blocked light

A silhouette may look like a shadow, but technically the concepts differ.

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### ## 34. shadow vs darkness

**darkness**

= general absence or low level of light

**\*\*黑暗\*\***

**\*\*shadow\*\***

= localized darker area caused by blocked light

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# Meaning map

The central physical concept of **\*\*shadow\*\*** is:

**\*\*a darker area created when light is blocked\*\***

From this develop:

### Literal shape

shadow on the wall

→ **\*\*影子\*\***

### Darkness

in shadow

→ **\*\*陰影中\*\***

### Negative influence

cast a shadow over

→ **\*\*蒙上陰影\*\***

### Reduced version

shadow of former self

→ **\*\*大不如前\*\***

### Following

shadow someone

→ **\*\*跟蹤 / 尾隨\*\***

### Training

shadow a professional

→ **\*\*跟隨觀摩\*\***

### Politics

shadow minister  
→ \*\*影子內閣職位\*\*

### ### Computing

shadow copy  
→ \*\*影子副本\*\*

### ### Graphics

drop shadow  
→ \*\*陰影效果\*\*

### ### Idiom

beyond a shadow of a doubt  
→ \*\*毫無疑問\*\*

The passage uses the literal physics branch:

\*\*light is blocked by the cup\*\*  
→ \*\*a dark shape appears on the wall\*\*  
→ \*\*shadow\*\*

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### # MCQ-ready master list

| Form / sense                      | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                             | -----                                 |
| **shadow — blocked-light shape**  | 物體阻擋光線後形成的暗色形狀；影子 / 陰影                |
| **cast a shadow**                 | 阻擋光線而投下影子                             |
| **shadow — dark area**            | 光線被遮擋後形成的較暗區域                         |
| **in shadow**                     | 處於光線不足或陰影之中                           |
| **shadow — faint outline**        | 遠處或光線不足時看到的模糊暗影 / 輪廓                  |
| **cast a shadow over something**  | 使事件、關係或情況受到負面影響；蒙上陰影                  |
| **under the shadow of...**        | 長期受到威脅、恐懼、記憶等負面影響                     |
| **a shadow of former self**       | 相比以前大幅衰退、只剩昔日的一小部分                    |
| **shadow someone — surveillance** | 暗中或持續跟蹤某人以觀察其行動                       |
| **shadow someone — training**     | 跟隨某位專業人士工作並觀摩學習                       |
| **job shadowing**                 | 透過跟隨他人工作來了解職業；職場觀摩                    |
| **shadow minister/cabinet**       | 反對黨中對應政府部長 / 內閣職位的影子職位                |
| **shadow copy**                   | 系統建立的次要或時間點資料副本；影子複本                  |
| **shadow — graphics**             | 文字、圖示等背後用來產生立體感的陰影效果                  |
| **drop shadow**                   | 圖形設計中位於物件後方的投影效果                      |

|                                       |                    |  |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------|--|
| <b>**eyeshadow**</b>                  | 塗在眼皮上的彩妝；眼影        |  |
| <b>**be someone's shadow**</b>        | 幾乎一直跟著某人；形影不離      |  |
| <b>**shadow of doubt**</b>            | 一絲懷疑或不確定           |  |
| <b>**beyond a shadow of a doubt**</b> | 完全確定；毫無疑問          |  |
| <b>**shadowy — dark**</b>             | 陰暗、輪廓模糊的           |  |
| <b>**shadowy — mysterious**</b>       | 不明朗、神祕或可疑的         |  |
| <b>**overshadow**</b>                 | 遮蔽；使相形失色；給……蒙上陰影   |  |
| <b>**foreshadow**</b>                 | 提前暗示或預示之後會發生的事情    |  |
| <b>**cast a long shadow**</b>         | 對之後長時間產生強烈、常為負面的影響 |  |
| <b>**live in someone's shadow**</b>   | 因另一人更受注意而被其光芒掩蓋    |  |

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## # Passage recap

> “...a cup, a torch, and a **\*\*shadow on the wall\*\***...”

Here:

**\*\*shadow\*\*** = **\*\*a dark shape formed when an object blocks light\*\***

Best Traditional Chinese:

\* **\*\*影子\*\***

\* **\*\*陰影\*\***

Natural contextual translation:

**\*\*一個杯子、一支手電筒和牆上的影子\*\***

## ### Passage MCQ-ready meaning

**\*\*shadow\*\***

= **\*\*a dark shape or area produced when an object blocks light\*\***

**\*\*影子；陰影\*\***

The essential physics contrast is:

> **\*\*shadow\*\***

> → 光被物體阻擋形成的暗區

versus:

> **\*\*reflection\*\***

> → 光線反射後形成的映像 / 倒影

and:

> **\*\*shade\*\***

> → 避開直射陽光的陰涼區域

In the passage, **\*\*shadow\*\*** is completely literal and forms part of Ms. Lau's light demonstration.